INCENSE STICKS

CATEGORY AUDIT

OBJECTIVE

Understand the global incense stick brands, map competitive positioning, identify opportunity for YAAD to stand out & build distinctive brand

OVERVIEW

- Traditional brands dominate, while lifestyle brands are reshaping packaging & storytelling.
- Premiumness is through natural ingredients, essential oils & crafted incense.
- Increasing demand from wellness-conscious consumers seeking relaxation, mindfulness & stress relief.

COMMON PATTERNS

























Earthy colour palettes

Nature-inspired illustrations

Emphasis on spirituality

Ingredient-focused

UNMET NEEDS

Sustainable packaging

Functional fragrances

Modern visual identity

INCENSE STICKS

COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE

India & Global



PHOOL
India

-Strong sustainability
-Premium, minimal
-Natural, charcoal-free
-Recognizable Innovation



NIRMALYA
India

-Affordable
-Leaf patterns
-Simplistic, minimal
-Sans serif text



PURE ELEMENTS
India

-Handmade, eco-friendly
-Mandala
-Spiritual Association
-Information Hierarchy



SATVIK
India

-Fragrance Identification
-Premium Illustrative Style
-Strong Colors
-Cultural Storytelling



YINECO
US

-Symbolic Illustrations
-Lifestyle-Oriented
-Balanced Composition
- Modern Minimalist



BODHA
US

-Monochromatic Palette
-Use of Negative Space
-Material Expression
-Embossed Detail



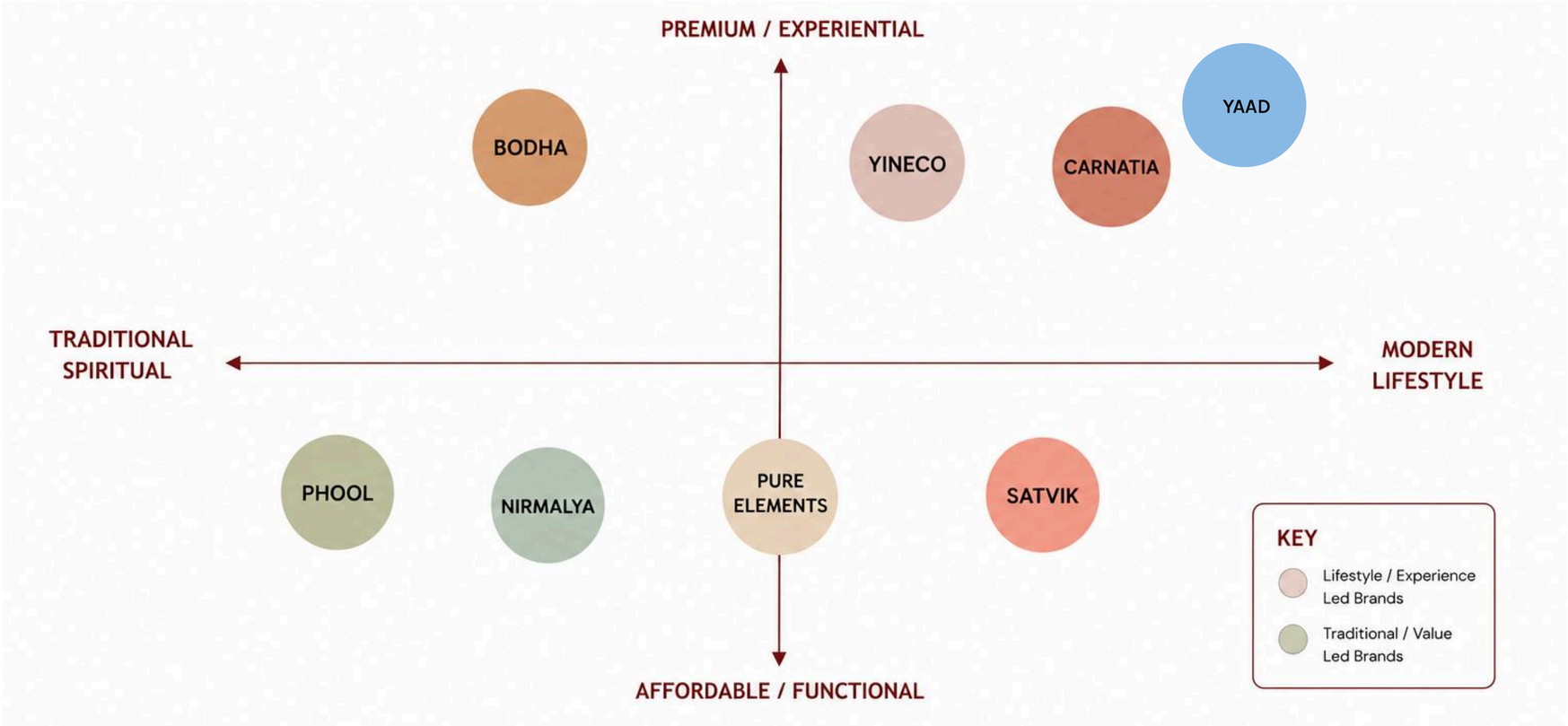
CARNATIA
India

-Landscape Illustrations
-Day-to-Night Storytelling
-Harmonious Colors
- Wellness Focused

BRAND SCOPE

Premium, emotional, contemporary
Indian identity through nostalgia

POSITION MAPPING



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Most brands communicate products—not memories.
- Traditional brands rely heavily on religious imagery.
- Wellness is becoming the dominant purchase driver.
- Packaging rarely creates a collectible experience.

INCENSE STICKS

AUDIENCE UNDERSTANDING

OBJECTIVE

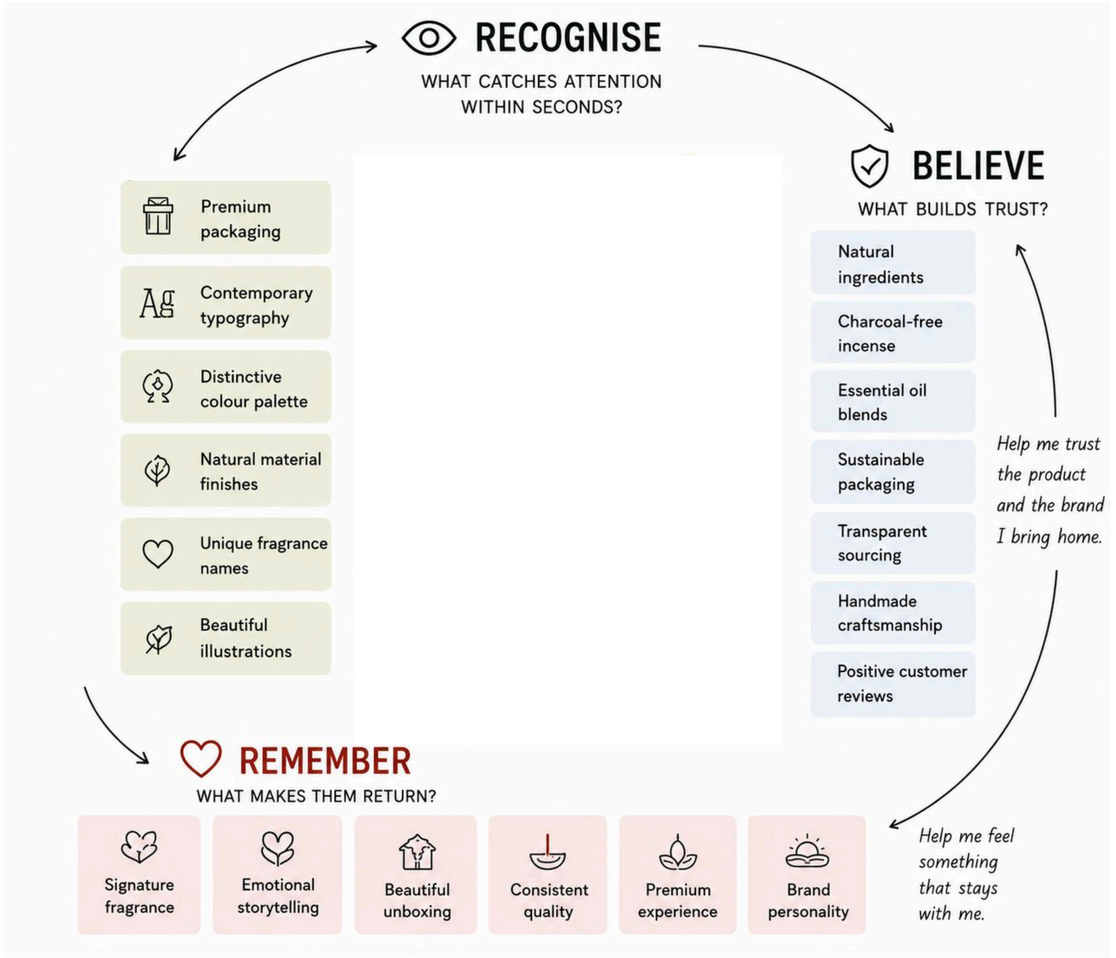
Understand the global incense stick brands, map competitive positioning, identify opportunity for YAAD to stand out & build distinctive brand

PERSONA



- **Age**: 24–45
- **Lifestyle**
  Wellness conscious
  Home décor enthusiast
  Values slow living
- **Values**
  Sustainability
  Self-care
  Authenticity
  Emotional wellbeing

DECISION JOURNEY



WHAT THEY NOTICE

- Packaging Design
- Brand Name
- Fragrance Variant
- Natural Ingredient Claims
- Material Finish

CONSUMER INSIGHTS



I prefer natural products without harsh chemicals.



Fragrance influences the personality.

SOAPS

CATEGORY AUDIT

OBJECTIVE

Understand the global soaps brands, map competitive positioning, identify opportunity for YAAD to stand out & build distinctive brand

OVERVIEW

- The category is evolving from basic cleansing to skin-benefit-led bathing rituals
- Choices are increasingly influenced by sensory experience—fragrance, texture, and packaging.
- Artisanal craftsmanship, and conscious formulations is more focused.

COMMON PATTERNS























- Handcrafted Visuals
- Botanical, Scientific
- Minimalism
- Ingredient-focused

UNMET NEEDS

- Personalization
- Beyond Skin Benefits
- Inclusive Design

SOAPS

COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE

India & Global



KAMA AYURVEDA-India

-Minimal luxury
-Earthy colours
-Heritage isnpired
-Botanical ingredient



PLUM BODY LOVIN'-India

-Bold colours
-Youth centric
-Fragrance first identity
-Playful brand



BIOTIQUE-India

-White dominance
-Ingredient hero
-Benefit led communication
-Brand signature



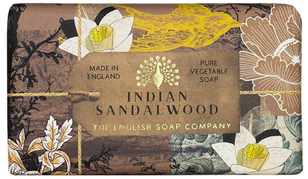
PACHA SOAP CO- US

-Artisanal aesthetic
-Illustrated design
-Bold colours
-Purpose driven packages



NUBIAN HERITAGE-US

-Patterns
-Cultural storytelling
-Balanced hierarchy
-Earthy color palette



THE ENGLISH SOAP COMPANY- UK

-Botanical illustration
-Gift oriented
-Heritage inspired
-Color coded fragrance



FRIENDLY SOAP- UK

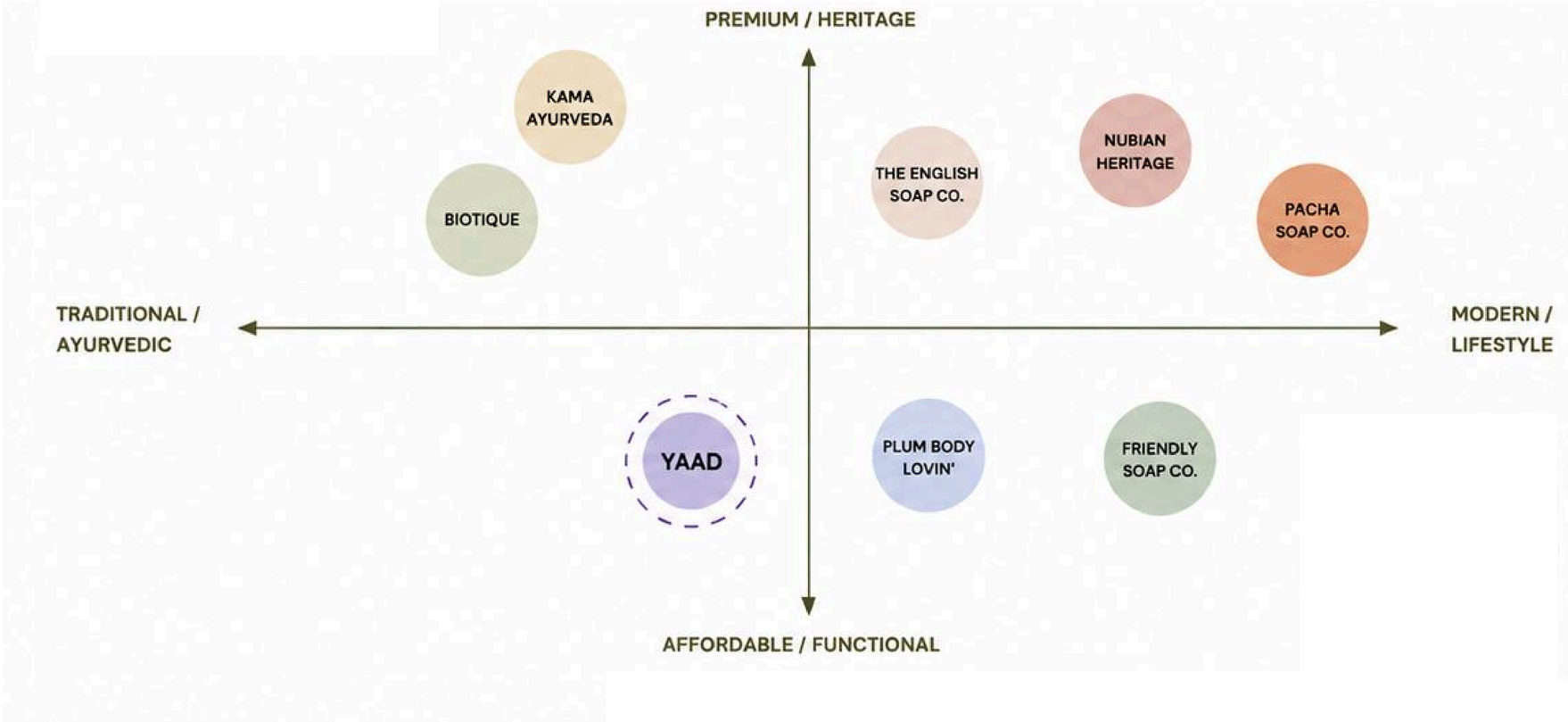
-Minimal design
-Solid colors
-Simple typography
-Certification icons

SOAPS

BRAND SCOPE

Premium, emotional, contemporary
Indian identity through nostalgia

POSITION MAPPING



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The category spans across traditional to modern lifestyle- led storytelling.
- It stands out with bold colors & playful identity.
- Affordable brands focus on function, ingredients & certifications.
- Brands lead with botanical & craftsmanship.

SOAPS

AUDIENCE UNDERSTANDING

OBJECTIVE

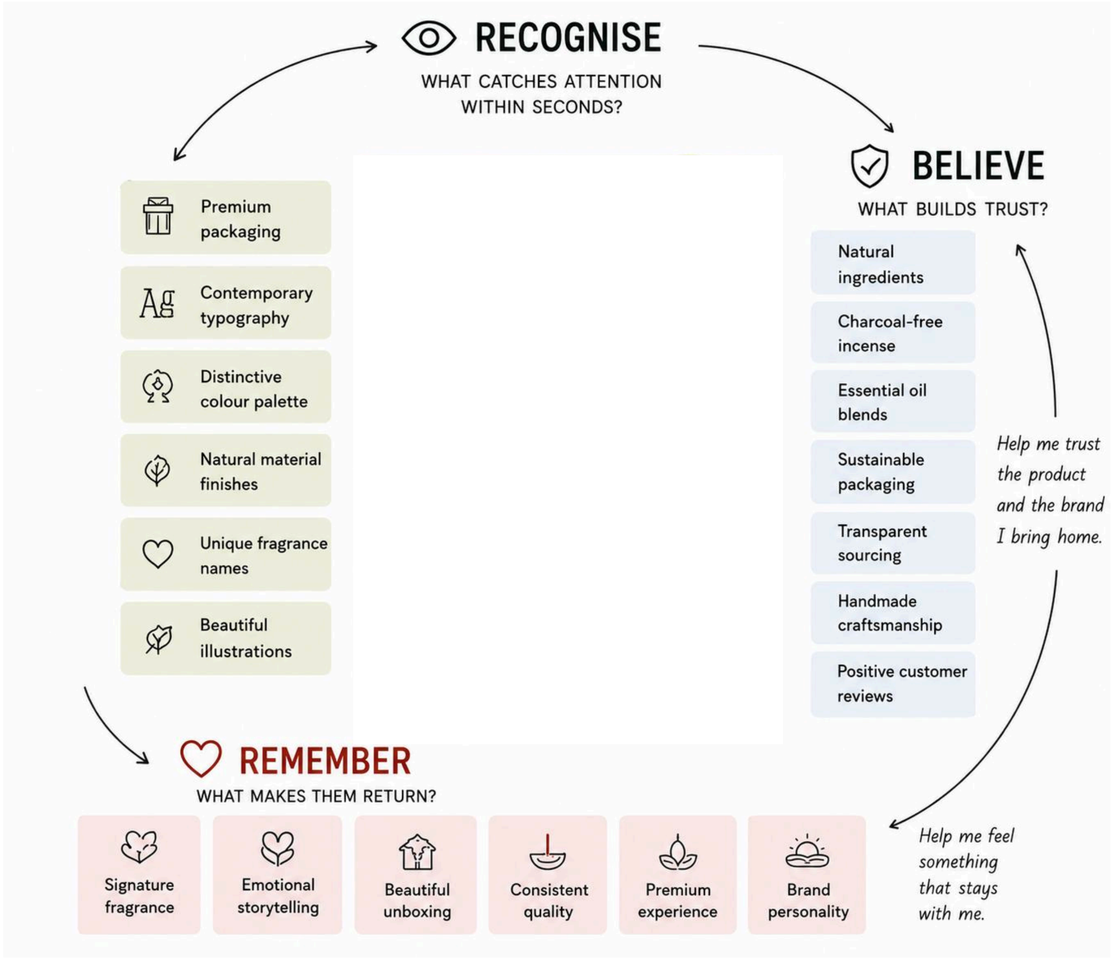
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PERSONA



- **Age**: 25-40
- **Lifestyle**
  Invests in skincare
  Everyday indulgences
  Shops online
- **Values**
  Natural ingredients
  Quality over quantity
  Personal expression
  Authenticity

DECISION JOURNEY



WHAT THEY NOTICE

- Packaging Design
- Typography
- Ingredient story
- Texture
- Sustainability

CONSUMER INSIGHTS



It’s not just a cleanser



Small act of self love

CANDLES

CATEGORY AUDIT

OBJECTIVE

Understand the global soaps brands, map competitive positioning, identify opportunity for YAAD to stand out & build distinctive brand

OVERVIEW

- Neutral palettes dominate premium candles.
- Gifting influences packaging structure.
- Sustainability is increasingly visible.
- Fragrance is the hero and creates mood for the packaging.

COMMON PATTERNS

























Typography Led

Storytelling Focused

Minimalism

Ingredient-focused

UNMET NEEDS

Refillable packaging

Less generic luxury

Indian scent storytelling

CANDLES

COMPETITOR LANDSCAPE

India & Global



NIANA -India

-Clean & minimal
-Muted color palette
-Restrained typography
-Emotional storytelling



DOFT -India

-Textured glass
-Decorative appearance
-Muted colors
-Craftsmanship



THE JUNE SHOP -India

-Minimalism
-Lifestyle object
-Fun & collectible
-Youthful



BLONDE HINOKI - US

-Retro & crafty
-Minimal typography
-Red debossed label



OTHERLAND -US

-Small artworks
-Creative fragrance
-Multiple scent notes
-Collectible



NEOM- UK

-Mood-led color coding
-Contemporary graphics
-Hierarchy
-Emotional benefit



SHEARER- UK

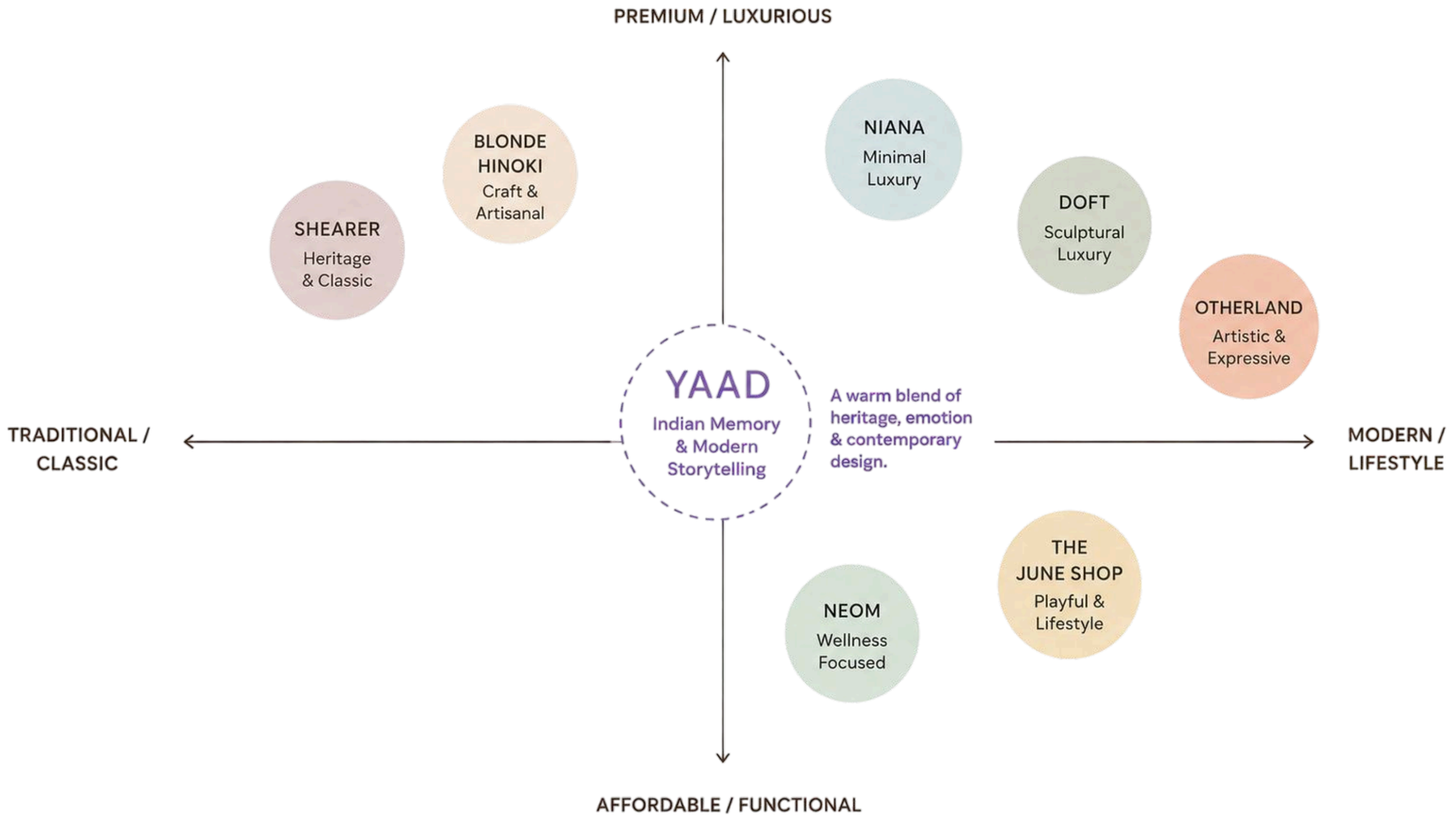
-Decorative details
-Seasonal packaging
-Heritage inspired
-Craftsmanship

CANDLES

BRAND SCOPE

Premium, emotional, contemporary
Indian identity through nostalgia

POSITION MAPPING



KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Premium is strongly associated with heritage.
- Minimalism dominates modern premium.
- Packaging is moving beyond functional communication.
- Gifting is a major opportunity

CANDLES

AUDIENCE UNDERSTANDING

OBJECTIVE

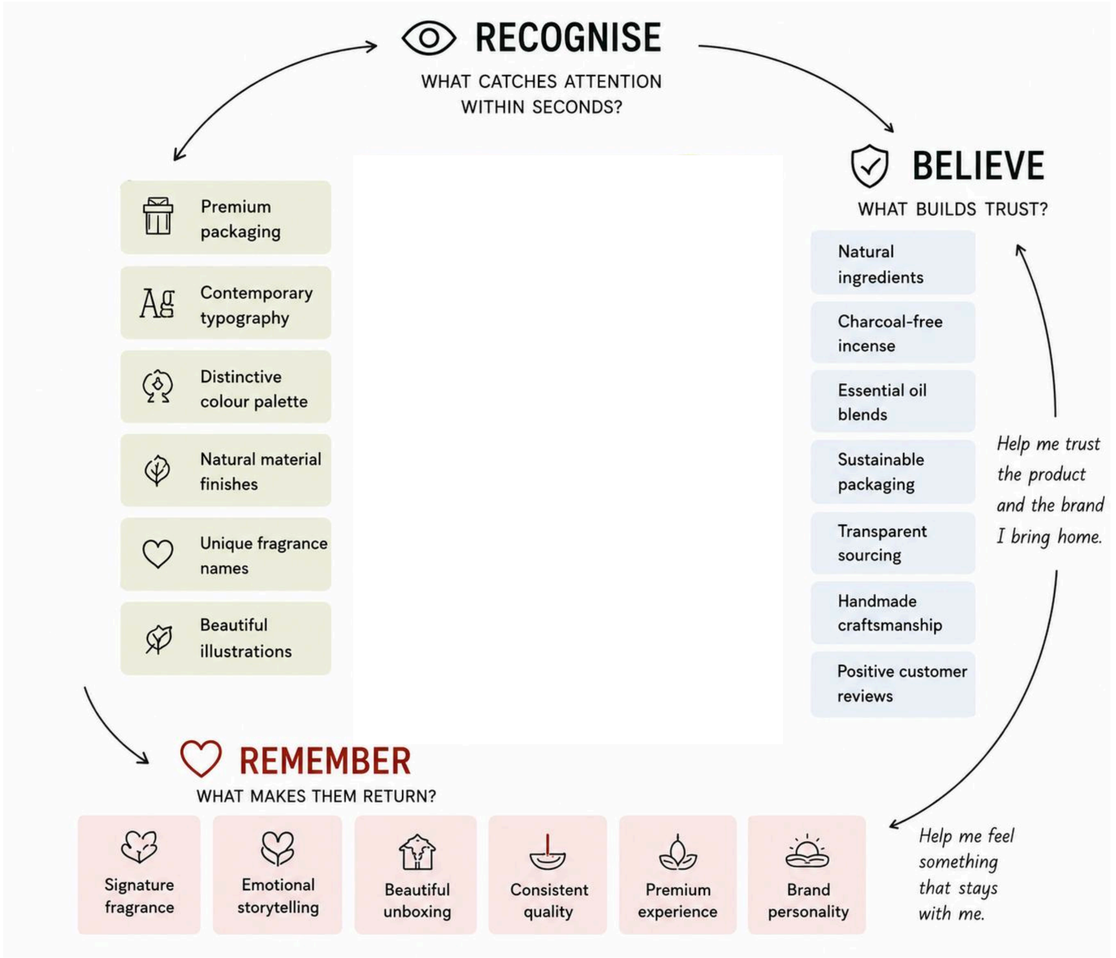
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PERSONA



- **Age**: 25-40
- **Lifestyle**
  Home Decor'
  Self care Rituals
  Personal Use, Gifting
- **Values**
  Well being
  Authenticity
  Emotional Connection
  Aesthetics

DECISION JOURNEY



WHAT THEY NOTICE

- Packaging Design
- Scent Notes
- Mood/ Emotion
- Craftsmanship
- Memory

CONSUMER INSIGHTS



It's not just about fragrance



Fit different moments of day